

COMPARISON • SPLIT • STRUCTURE

# compare-prose

Two prose options side-by-side with a labeled corner tag on each.

## Two options, equal footing, corner tags.

### THE LEFT OPTION

Each pane holds one option's case in up to twenty words of prose, tagged at the corner.



### THE RIGHT OPTION

The panes stay symmetric; a longer case belongs in the vertical variant, not a taller card.

# transition reads left as before, right as after.

## BEFORE

The arrow between the panes turns comparison into change over time.



## AFTER

Use it for state changes, not preferences — the arrow implies causation.

# mirror swaps the reading order.

## FIRST OPTION

Same anatomy, flipped; the corner tags travel with their panes.



## SECOND OPTION

mirror renders this pane first — for when the deck's rhythm lands on the left.

# chosen crowns the right pane the winner.

## THE ROAD NOT TAKEN

The losing option keeps its full case — an honest comparison shows real strength.



## THE VERDICT

The accent treatment marks this pane as the pick; pair with a reason, not a repeat.

# decision stamps the verdict banner across the pair.

## OPTION ONE

Both panes stay equal; the banner above carries the call.



## OPTION TWO

Use when the decision is made and the slide is the record.

## vertical stacks the panes for longer cases.

### THE TOP OPTION

Stacking buys full slide width, so a case may run toward its ceiling without the columns pinching.



### THE BOTTOM OPTION

The trade is simultaneity — the eye compares in sequence, so lead with the keeper.

## banner-tag fills the corner tags at banner weight.

OPTION A

The tag takes the accent fill and full contrast.



OPTION B

Use for short, loud labels — verdicts, camps, teams.



# rejected strikes the losing pane.

## THE PICK

The surviving option reads at full strength.



## THE REJECTED PANE

Dimmed and struck — the record of what was considered and declined.

## The second axis: how far it reaches.

The verb is one axis — how you think. **Reach** is the other — how far what you make travels.

### I

#### Own the verb

You can do the cognitive work — correct, clear, complete. So far it reaches only you.



### II

#### Widen the reach

The work travels: team, org, field — the farther it carries, the higher the level.

♦ *Most engineers stall here — not on the thinking, but on making it travel past their own hands.*

# Two full cases is the most this pair holds.

## THE STRESSED TOP PANE

A case at the hard budget runs about this long: two full sentences that state the option, its strongest argument, and the cost it accepts — and then stops.



## THE STRESSED BOTTOM PANE

Symmetry matters most at the ceiling; when one pane runs half the other's length, the slide reads as a verdict the author did not intend to give.

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# When NOT to reach for compare-prose.

## Code comparison

Use `compare-code` for two fenced blocks. `compare-prose` is for sentences, not snippets.

## Three or more options

`compare-prose` is strictly two. For three or more, use `cards-grid three` or `verdict-grid` with criteria badges.

## Verbatim text differences

When the diff lives inside the prose itself — legal language, contract clauses — use `redline` so insertions and deletions render inline.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`compare-code` — the columns are code, not prose

`split-compare` — the verdict needs a bottom recommendation bar

`verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared  
criteria

`decision` — the verdict slide that lands after a comparison